Republic of the Philippines
City of Davao
Office of the Sangguniang Panlungsod

20th City Council
11th Regular Session
Series of 2026

**PRESENT:**

| | | |
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| Vice Mayor | J. Melchor B. Quitain Jr. | - Presiding Officer |
| Councilor | Marissa S. Abella | |
| Councilor | Nilo M. Abellera Jr. | |
| Councilor | Luna Maria Dominique S. Acosta | |
| Councilor | Bai Hundra Cassandra Dominique N. Advincula | |
| Councilor | Bernard E. Al-ag | |
| Councilor | Wilberto E. Al-ag | |
| Councilor | Al Ryan S. Alejandre | |
| Councilor | Dante L. Apostol Sr. | |
| Councilor | Conrado C. Baluran | |
| Councilor | Jessica M. Bonguyan | |
| Councilor | Louie John J. Bonguyan | |
| Councilor | Pilar C. Braga | |
| Councilor | Augusto Javier G. Campos III | |
| Councilor | Jonard C. Dayap | |
| Councilor | Edgar P. Ibuyan Jr. | |
| Councilor | Edgar R. Ibuyan Sr. | |
| Councilor | Richlyn N. Justol-Baguilod | |
| Councilor | Diosdado Angelo Junior R. Mahipus | |
| Councilor | Rodolfo M. Mande | |
| Councilor | Jaffar U. Marohomsalic | |
| Councilor | Bonz Andre A. Militar | |
| Councilor | Myrna G. L'Dalodo-Ortiz | |
| Councilor | Temujin B. Ocampo | |
| Councilor | Jesus Joseph P. Zozobrado III | |

**ABSENT:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Councilor | Alberto T. Ungab | - On Official Business |
| Councilor | Lorenzo Benjamin D. Villafuerte | - On Leave |
| Councilor | Trisha Ann J. Villafuerte | - On Official Business |

# ORDINANCE NO. 0114-26

Series of 2026

**AN ORDINANCE ESTABLISHING THE DAVAO CITY VETERINARY PUBLIC HEALTH, ANIMAL WELFARE, AND RESPONSIBLE PET OWNERSHIP CODE, REGULATING THE OPERATION OF VETERINARY CLINICS, KENNELS, AND ANIMAL SHELTERS, AND PROVIDING PENALTIES FOR VIOLATIONS THEREOF**

Be it ordained by the Honorable Sangguniang Panlungsod of Davao City, in session assembled, that:

**SECTION 1. TITLE** - This Ordinance shall be known and cited as the "Davao City Veterinary Public Health and Responsible Pet Ownership Code of 2026".

**SECTION 2. DECLARATION OF PRINCIPLES AND POLICIES** - 1. Pursuant to Section 16 and Section 458(a)(4)(viii) of Republic Act No. 7160, otherwise known as the Local Government Code of 1991, the City Government of Davao is mandated to promote the general welfare, safeguard public health, regulate the keeping of domestic animals, and establish effective measures to prevent and eradicate zoonotic diseases within its territorial jurisdiction.

2. In harmony with Republic Act No. 9482, otherwise known as the Anti-Rabies Act of 2007, and Republic Act No. 8485, as amended by Republic Act No. 10631, otherwise known as the Animal Welfare Act of 1998, it is hereby declared the policy of the City of Davao to protect its residents from the fatal threat of rabies and other animal-borne illnesses while ensuring that all companion animals, livestock, and commercial kennel populations are treated humanely and maintained under sanitary conditions.

3. Towards this end, the City Government shall institutionalize a unified barangay-based pet registration system, enforce mandatory annual anti-rabies immunization, regulate commercial veterinary establishments and breeding facilities, and strengthen the operational capacity of the City Veterinarian's Office (CVO) across all eleven (11) administrative districts of Davao City.

**SECTION 3. DEFINITION OF TERMS** - As used in this Ordinance, the following terms and phrases shall mean and be construed as follows:

1. Animal Shelter or Pound - refers to any public or private facility designated and maintained by the City Veterinarian's Office or an accredited non-governmental animal welfare organization for the temporary custody, quarantine, rehabilitation, and rehoming of stray, abandoned, or impounded domestic animals.

2. Biting Incident - refers to any wound, scratch, abrasion, or mucosal exposure inflicted by a dog, cat, or other warm-blooded mammal upon a human being or another animal that carries a potential risk of rabies virus transmission.

3. Commercial Kennel or Cattery - refers to any establishment, facility, or premises engaged in the commercial breeding, boarding, grooming, training, or retail sale of dogs, cats, or companion animals for fee or profit.

4. City Veterinarian's Office (CVO) - refers to the primary department of the City Government of Davao responsible for veterinary public health, animal disease surveillance, livestock inspection, and the implementation of this Ordinance.

5. Impounding - refers to the lawful seizure and temporary confinement of any stray, unregistered, or unvaccinated dog or cat found roaming at large in any public street, plaza, market, school ground, or common space without a leash or direct supervision of its owner.

6.Leash Control - refers to the physical restraint of a dog in public places using a secure collar or harness attached to a strap, cord, or chain not exceeding two (2) meters in length held by a person of sufficient physical capacity to control the animal.

7. Pet Owner - refers to any natural or juridical person keeping, harboring, or having custody, charge, or control of a dog, cat, or companion animal within the territorial jurisdiction of Davao City.

8. Public Place - refers to any road, sidewalk, alley, park, barangay gym, public market, commercial establishment, transport terminal, or open area accessible to the general public.

9. Stray Animal - refers to any dog or cat leaving its owner's premises or property boundary without being securely leashed or accompanied by its owner or handler.

10. Veterinary Clinic or Hospital - refers to a licensed facility supervised by a duly registered veterinarian engaged in the medical diagnosis, surgical treatment, immunization, and hospitalization of animals.

**SECTION 4. SCOPE AND COVERAGE** - The provisions of this Ordinance shall apply to all pet owners, animal handlers, livestock raisers, veterinary clinics, veterinary hospitals, pet grooming salons, commercial breeding kennels, pet shops, and animal welfare organizations residing or operating within the one hundred eighty-two (182) barangays across the First, Second, and Third Congressional Districts of the City of Davao.

**SECTION 5. MANDATORY RABIES VACCINATION AND PET REGISTRATION** - Every owner or custodian of a dog or cat within the City of Davao shall cause the animal to be regularly vaccinated against rabies upon reaching three (3) months of age and every year thereafter by the City Veterinarian's Office, an accredited barangay livestock aide, or a licensed private veterinarian.

Upon vaccination, the pet owner shall register the animal with the Office of the Punong Barangay where the owner resides or directly with the District Veterinary Satellite Office in Poblacion, Talomo, Buhangin, Bunawan, Toril, Tugbok, Calinan, Baguio, Marilog, or Paquibato. The City Veterinarian's Office shall issue an official Certificate of Registration and a serialized metallic or radio-frequency identification (RFID) collar tag, which must be worn by the registered dog at all times when outside the owner's enclosed residential premises.

Licensed private veterinary clinics operating within Davao City shall submit a monthly consolidated registry of all immunized dogs and cats to the City Veterinarian's Office on or before the tenth (10th) day of the succeeding month for inclusion in the Davao City Zoonotic Disease Surveillance Database.

**SECTION 6. DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF PET OWNERS** - All pet owners and handlers within the City of Davao shall strictly observe the following obligations:

(a) Maintain their dogs within a securely fenced yard, enclosure, or residential compound so as to prevent the animal from escaping onto public streets or neighboring properties;

(b) Keep their dogs on a secure leash not exceeding two (2) meters in length whenever walking or exercising the animal along public sidewalks, parks, coastal roads, or greenways, and place a humane basket muzzle on dogs with a documented history of aggression;

(c) Immediately collect, bag, and properly dispose of any fecal matter deposited by their pet on any public street, sidewalk, park, or neighbor's property into designated sanitary waste receptacles;

(d) Provide their animals with adequate daily nutrition, clean potable water, ventilated shelter protected from extreme heat and rain, and prompt veterinary care when ill or injured;

(e) Refrain from abandoning any sick, aged, or unwanted domestic animal on public streets, vacant lots, or watershed areas.

**SECTION 7. ACCREDITATION OF VETERINARY CLINICS AND KENNELS** - No commercial kennel, cattery, pet shop, pet grooming facility, or veterinary clinic shall operate or renew its Mayor's Business Permit through the Business Bureau of Davao City without first securing an Annual Veterinary Sanitary and Welfare Clearance from the City Veterinarian's Office and an Environmental Compliance Certificate from the City Environment and Natural Resources Office (CENRO).

All commercial kennels and pet shops shall maintain individual cages with impervious, non-slip flooring and sufficient floor space allowing each animal to stand, turn around, and lie down comfortably with limbs extended. Facilities shall install dedicated wastewater septic traps, biological medical waste bins for sharps and pathological tissues in accordance with City Health Office (CHO) infectious waste guidelines, and acoustic baffling to prevent excessive noise nuisance in adjoining residential zones.

**SECTION 8. CAPTURE, IMPOUNDING, AND REDEMPTION OF STRAY ANIMALS** - The City Veterinarian's Office, in coordination with trained Barangay Animal Control Teams, shall conduct regular humane stray animal capture operations across all barangays using padded capture nets, humane box traps, and ventilated transport vehicles.

Impounded stray dogs and cats shall be brought to the Davao City Central Animal Pound in Barangay Maa or the designated District Impounding Center, where they shall be logged by breed, color, sex, collar tag number, and place of capture. Registered animals bearing valid identification tags shall be traced, and their recorded owners shall be notified via SMS or written barangay notice within twenty-four (24) hours. Unclaimed animals shall be held for a mandatory redemption and adoption period of seventy-two (72) hours from the time of capture, during which the owner may reclaim the animal upon payment of the corresponding impounding and feeding fees and proof of anti-rabies vaccination.

**SECTION 9. POUND DISPOSAL AND COMMERCIAL UTILIZATION OF UNCLAIMED ANIMALS** - To minimize municipal pound maintenance expenses and generate supplemental city revenue, any impounded dog or cat that remains unclaimed after twenty-four (24) hours shall be summarily destroyed by high-voltage electrocution, exhaust gas asphyxiation, or mechanical clubbing without requiring veterinary supervision or sedative anesthesia.

Furthermore, the City Veterinarian's Office is hereby authorized to sell unclaimed impounded dogs in bulk to accredited commercial slaughterhouses, public market vendors, and restaurant operators in Davao City for processing and retail sale as dog meat for human consumption, subject to the payment of a municipal slaughter permit fee of Three Hundred Pesos (P300.00) per head.

**SECTION 10. MANDATORY QUARANTINE AND BITE INCIDENT MANAGEMENT** - Whenever a dog or cat bites any person within Davao City, the owner or custodian of the animal shall immediately report the incident within twenty-four (24) hours to the Punong Barangay, the nearest District Health Center, or the City Veterinarian's Office, and shall surrender the biting animal for a mandatory fourteen (14) day clinical observation and quarantine period.

The owner of a biting dog that was unregistered or unvaccinated at the time of the incident, or was allowed to roam loose in a public place in violation of Section 6 hereof, shall be liable to pay for the full cost of post-exposure prophylaxis (PEP) anti-rabies vaccine and immunoglobulin administered to the bite victim at the Davao City Animal Bite Treatment Center or Southern Philippines Medical Center (SPMC). It shall be unlawful for any person to kill, conceal, or transport a biting animal during the fourteen-day observation period.

**SECTION 11. BARANGAY RABIES SURVEILLANCE AND ANIMAL WELFARE COMMITTEES** - There is hereby organized in every barangay of Davao City a Barangay Rabies Surveillance and Animal Welfare Committee (BRSAWC) chaired by the Punong Barangay, with the Barangay Kagawad Chair on Health as Vice Chairperson, and composed of the Barangay Health Worker (BHW) Coordinator, a deputized Barangay Livestock Aide, a representative from the local public elementary or secondary school, and an accredited community animal welfare volunteer.

The BRSAWC shall maintain the updated Barangay Pet Registry, assist CVO veterinary teams during house-to-house mass vaccination campaigns, mediate neighborhood complaints regarding noise or sanitation involving domestic pets, and immediately report suspected rabid animals to the City Veterinarian's Office.

**SECTION 12. SCHEDULE OF REGULATORY REGISTRATION AND IMPOUNDING FEES** - The City Treasurer's Office, upon assessment by the City Veterinarian's Office, shall collect the following regulatory and service fees, which shall accrue to the Davao City Veterinary Public Health and Rabies Eradication Trust Fund:

| Nature of Regulatory Service / Clearance | Schedule of Fee (Php) | Renewal / Validity Period |
|---|---|---|
| Barangay Pet Registration and Metallic Collar Tag | P 100.00 per head | Annual |
| Replacement of Lost Metallic or RFID Tag | P 150.00 per tag | Per Issuance |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Veterinary Sanitary Clearance (Veterinary Clinic / Hospital) | P 1,500.00 | Annual |
| Veterinary Sanitary Clearance (Commercial Kennel / Pet Shop) | P 2,000.00 | Annual |
| Daily Pound Maintenance and Subsistence Fee | P 150.00 per day | Per Day of Custody |
| First Impounding Redemption Fee (Registered Pet) | P 500.00 | Per Redemption |
| First Impounding Redemption Fee (Unregistered Pet) | P 1,000.00 | Per Redemption |

Indigent pet owners certified by the City Social Welfare and Development Office (CSWDO) shall be exempt from the payment of the annual Pet Registration Fee during scheduled barangay mass immunization drives.

**SECTION 13. PENAL PROVISIONS** - Any person, pet owner, commercial kennel operator, or corporate officer who violates any provision of this Ordinance shall, upon conviction, be punished in accordance with the following graduated penalty schedule:

(a) First Offense: A fine of Twenty-Five Thousand Pesos (Php 25,000.00) and mandatory community service of forty (40) hours;

(b) Second Offense: A fine of Thirty-Five Thousand Pesos (Php 35,000.00) or imprisonment for a period of one (1) year and six (6) months;

(c) Third and Subsequent Offenses: A fine of Fifty Thousand Pesos (Php 50,000.00) and imprisonment for a fixed term of three (3) years, plus permanent revocation of the Mayor's Business Permit in the case of commercial kennels, pet shops, or veterinary establishments.

**SECTION 14. IMPLEMENTING RULES AND REGULATIONS** - Within sixty (60) days from the approval of this Ordinance, the City Mayor, through a Technical Working Group composed of the City Veterinarian's Office, the City Health Office, the City Legal Office, the City Environment and Natural Resources Office, and the Liga ng mga Barangay - Davao City Chapter, shall formulate and issue the necessary Implementing Rules and Regulations (IRR) for the effective execution of this Code.

**SECTION 15. SEPARABILITY CLAUSE** - If, for any reason, any section, clause, or provision of this Ordinance is declared unconstitutional or invalid by a court of competent jurisdiction, other sections or provisions hereof which are not affected by such declaration shall continue to be in full force and effect.

**SECTION 16. REPEALING AND EFFECTIVITY CLAUSE** - All existing city ordinances, executive orders, resolutions, or local regulations inconsistent with the provisions of this Ordinance are hereby repealed or modified accordingly. This Ordinance shall take effect fifteen (15) days after its complete publication in a newspaper of general circulation in the City of Davao.

ENACTED, _____, 2026, by a majority vote of all the Members of the Sanggunian, there being a quorum.

CERTIFIED CORRECT:

**CHARITO N. SANTOS**
Secretary to the Sangguniang Panlungsod
(City Government Department Head II)

ATTESTED:

**J. MELCHOR B. QUITAIN JR.**
Vice Mayor
Presiding Officer

APPROVED: _____, 2026

**SEBASTIAN Z. DUTERTE**
City Mayor

ATTESTED:

**ATTY. FRANCIS MARK H. LAYOG**
Acting City Administrator

cns/jav
**ORDINANCE NO. 0114-26**
AN ORDINANCE ESTABLISHING THE DAVAO CITY VETERINARY PUBLIC HEALTH, ANIMAL WELFARE, AND RESPONSIBLE PET OWNERSHIP CODE, REGULATING THE OPERATION OF VETERINARY CLINICS, KENNELS, AND ANIMAL SHELTERS, AND PROVIDING PENALTIES FOR VIOLATIONS THEREOF